

Ethical and Legal Declarations

Generic declaration text for the submission form. Transfer these answers into the live Benjamins/IJCL prompts and adjust wording only where the form requires a specific label.

Human and animal subjects. This study involves no human or animal subjects. No human-subjects data is used; the corpora named in the worked example are illustrative, not analyzed.

Informed consent. Not applicable (no human participants).

Ethics approval. Not applicable (no human or animal research).

Competing / conflicting interests. The author declares no competing interests.

Funding. No funding was received for this work.

Data and code availability. The simulations are reproduced by three short, deterministic Python scripts (standard library only, fixed random seeds), provided as supplementary material; they reproduce the reported numbers exactly. No other data is used.

Authorship. Single author (Brett Reynolds), sole contributor to all aspects of the work.

Use of generative AI. Large language models (Claude Opus 4.8 and OpenAI Codex) were used as drafting and editing aids. The author is responsible for all theoretical claims, arguments, errors, and interpretive choices. (Also stated in the cover letter.)

Originality / prior publication. The manuscript is original and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere.